

Raul Pacheco-Vega, PhD

Understanding and solving intractable resource governance problems.

ABOUT ME BLOG CONSULTING CONTACT MY RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS RESOURCES TALKS TEACHING WORKSHOPS

Log in

Warning Search

9
SHARES



Reading, scribbling, highlighting, taking notes and organizing information from a journal article or book chapter – walking through my digital and analog processes

I have written several Twitter threads about how do what many people call “**active reading**”: I read, highlight, scribble on the margins, take notes and then store these in digital and analog media. I use **highlighting and writing marginalia to engage more deeply with the reading materials I am working with**. I’ve also posted here on my website the most recent iteration of my **colour-coded highlighting and scribbling process**. This note-taking process generates material that I then store either in analog form (Everything Notebook, index cards, Cornell Notes), or in digital form (memorandums, synthetic notes, rhetorical precis or Conceptual Synthesis Excel Dump rows)



A couple of days ago, I posted a Twitter thread showcasing my highlighting and scribbling and note-taking, as well as summarizing and organizing information digitally (and analogically). I decided to transfer my Twitter threads to a more permanent medium (my blog) so those who are interested in following similar approaches to **active reading, literature reviewing and note-taking** can do so. In this post I included several threads in order to make it easier for people to see different examples.



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Feb 27, 2019



@raulpacheco ·

I’m going to use this paper to showcase how I highlight, scribble and file my printed materials. I use Sharpie fineliners to write, Stick’n rigid plastic tabs to sort and organize and I’m testing these Faber-Castell highlighters.



SUBSCRIBE



About Raul Pacheco-Vega, PhD

I am a Full Professor with the Methods Lab at the Facultad Latinoamericana de Ciencias Sociales (FLACSO) Sede Mexico. My research is interdisciplinary by nature, and I identify both as a political scientist and as a human geographer, the two fields in which I trained during my doctorate. For a long time, my work centered [...]

more →

Find Me Online

My Research Output

- > Google Scholar Profile
- > E-mail
- > Academia.Edu
- > ResearchGate
- > Mendeley
- > ORCID

My Social Networks

- > Twitter / X
- > Facebook
- > LinkedIn
- > BlueSky

Recent Posts

- > How to map out debates in the scholarly literature
- > Making our research dialogue with the broader scholarly literature in our academic writing
- > A guiding framework to help learners write more analytically by focusing on the Description, Analysis and Interpretation stages of the research process (GReDAI)
- > Gap-spotting, problematization, finding a niche: How can researchers develop their contribution to the literature?
- > Doing a project per career stage versus executing multiple projects: Pros, cons and my own experience

Recent Comments

- > Gamegeek on Should public administration scholarship be subjected to the same transparency standards as political science? A response to Lars Tummers
- > ministitch1 on Reading, scribbling, highlighting, taking notes and organizing information from a journal article or book chapter – walking through my digital and analog processes
- > slot depo 5k on My Top 10 academic productivity tips, or how I submitted 5 pieces in 3 weeks
- > udinslot[jago168]djarur on Reshaping incentives: Encouraging tap water instead of bottled water
- > udinslot[jago168]djarur on How to make your claim of novelty and contributions to the scholarly literature VERY clear with an example

Archives

Select Month ▼



art and Planning D. Society and Space 2013, volume 31, pages 280-299

DOI: 10.1080/026410511.0191111

Constructing 'public water': the World Bank, urban supply, and the biopolitics of development

University of British Columbia, 1984 West Mall, Vancouver BC V6T 1Z2, Canada
Email: jay@ubc.ca

2011; in revised form 10 November 2011

This is a historical analysis of the evolution of the World Bank's water supply networks, from 1960 to the late 1990s. The analysis argues that the World Bank agenda to extend the biopolitical (manageable public/private binary) that contributed to the concept of 'state failure', and an associated agenda of politics, development

[Read 1 reply](#)

X

WPS
water
policies
urban
supply
networks
1960-1980s

contradictions
↓
untenable
binary
public-
private

Abstract. This paper presents a historical analysis of the evolution of the World Bank's policies on urban water supply networks, from 1960 to the late 1980s. The analysis frames urban water supply as an attempt (and an attempt) to extend the biopolitical power of developmental statist argument (and an untenable public/private binary) that contributed to a set of contradictions and the urban water supply in the late 1960s. This perspective enables critical reflection on the historical origins of the concept of 'state failure' and on contemporary debates over urbanization, infrastructure, and development.

Keywords: World Bank, public, biopolitics, development

critical reflection
on state failure
+ debates on urban...

Introduction

Over the past few decades, providing 'water for all' has become one of the central goals of development organizations, as enshrined (for example) in the Millennium Development Goals. Yet water supply also presents development practitioners and theorists with a conundrum: While water supply appears to be essential and 'state failure', sustainable governance frameworks for caught between 'market failure' and 'state failure', this conundrum lies at the heart of contemporary debates over water supply—and indeed, of debates over development, urbanization, and citizenship more generally.

In order to provide historical context for understanding this contemporary debate, this paper presents an analysis of the evolution of the World Bank's policies on urban water supply networks.¹ Over three decades (from 1960 to the late 1980s), the World Bank (hereafter 'the Bank') became a—if not the—major actor in development policy in this area. Much of the contemporary literature assumes that the Bank was an active and committed policy

in the 1960s-1980s. In so...



This post describes how I organize my books and

and this one describes the AIC summarization method raulpacheco.org/2017/01/findin... I re-emphasize: AIC is NOT a substitute for deeper engagement. You may need to re-read in more depth, again.

2:41 AM · Feb 27, 2019

50 Copy link

Read 3 replies

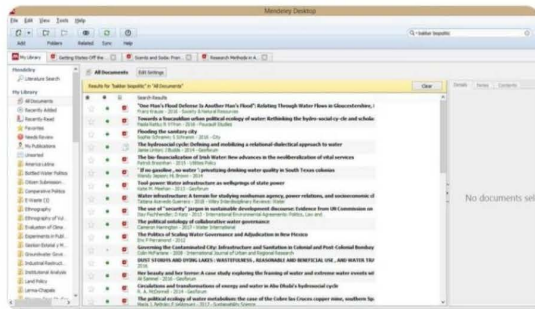


Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Feb 27, 2019

@raulpacheco

Replying to @raulpacheco

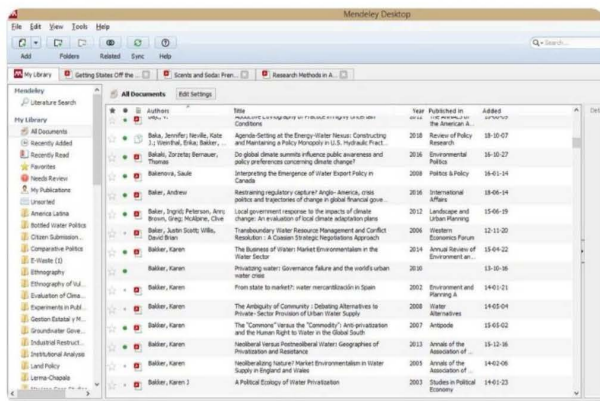
Shocking to me, I did not have this paper in my Mendeley library even if I do have the PDF in my Dropbox. I found this out by searching my database for the author and a keyword. I use Mendeley, you can use Zotero, Refworks, Papers, Citavi, whatever. raulpacheco.org/2018/12/a-brie...



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco

I did a second search (organizing by Author). I thought I had read EVERYTHING that Karen Bakker had published, but apparently not. What I'll do is add this PDF to my "PDFs" folder associated with this particular paper I'm writing, and have Mendeley automagically import it.



2:48 AM · Feb 27, 2019

24 Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Feb 27, 2019

@raulpacheco

Replying to @raulpacheco

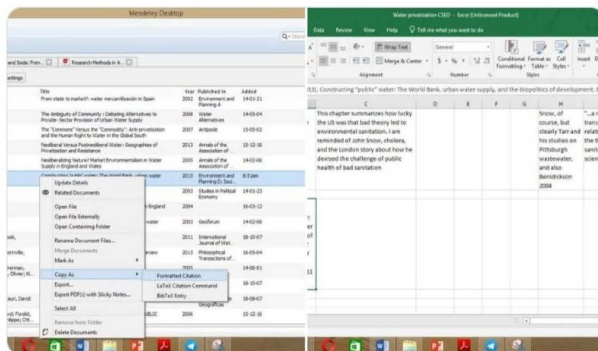
This post outlines how I organize the digital copies of my printed files raulpacheco.org/2015/09/organ... - in a previous tweet, I linked to a Mendeley guide I wrote. This guide explains how to have Mendeley "Watch A Folder" for automagical importing of PDFs. A clean reference uploaded!





Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega
@raulpacheco

Now, you know I organize my readings through a Conceptual Synthesis Excel Dump. I have a CSED for "Water Privatization". Therefore, this paper will end up there. I use Mendeley's "Copy as Formatted Citation" function to copy the reference on to my CSED.



2:54 AM · Feb 27, 2019

23 ❤️

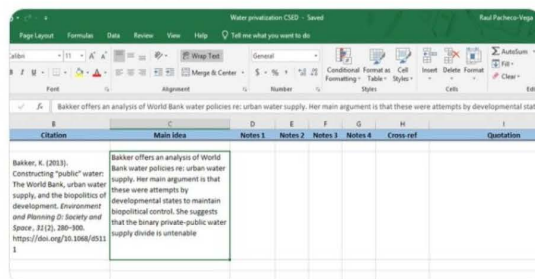
🔗 Copy link

Read 3 replies

Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Feb 27, 2019
@raulpacheco

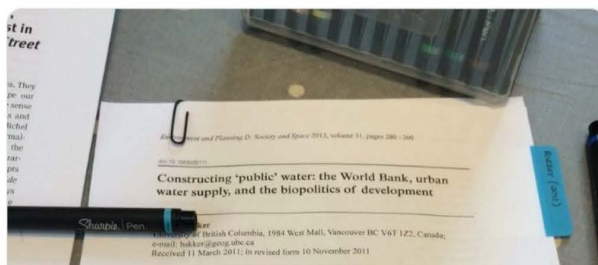
Replying to @raulpacheco

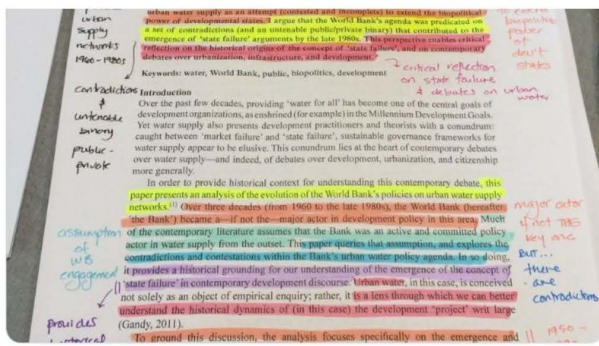
I use highlighted components of this paper to fill out CSED cells. One reason why I suggest that it is useful to AIC skim a paper and do a CSED row raulpacheco.org/2017/12/carvin... is that the more you read, the easier it is to gain a broad overview of the field, and find key papers.



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega
@raulpacheco

I use a multilevel approach to highlighting - yellow for key idea, orange for second level of importance, pink, green, blue, purple for 3, 4, 5, 6th levels of relevancy. Note how I scribble not only a summary but also my own insights, reflections, opinions, contrasting views.





3:10 AM · Feb 27, 2019



54



Copy link

Read 2 replies



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Feb 27, 2019

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

This is an updated version of my highlighting and scribbling approach. raulpacheco.org/2018/03/an-upd... Also, verdict on the Faber-Castell highlighters. Yes to yellow (AMAZING), pastel blue, purple. Pink and orange are dark and dull. Dark blue is too dark to be readable. Incomplete set.



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

What ends up happening when I am not happy with an entire set of highlighters is that I end up with a mix-and-match melange (mixture in French). I use a combo: pastel purple and pastel blue (Stabilo Boss Original) and yellow, pink, green and orange (Staedtler Triplus Hilight).



3:21 AM · Feb 27, 2019



24



Copy link

Read 4 replies

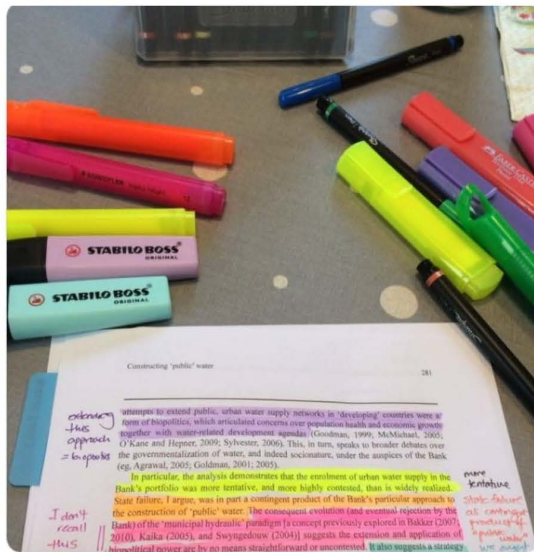


Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Feb 27, 2019

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

I used the Stabilo and Staedtler ones on this paragraph. Note how much nicer these are compared to Faber-Castell. Also note how Bakker repeats core ideas she outlined on the abstract. I found 2 ideas I wanted to probe more in depth (state failure, municipal hydraulic paradigm).



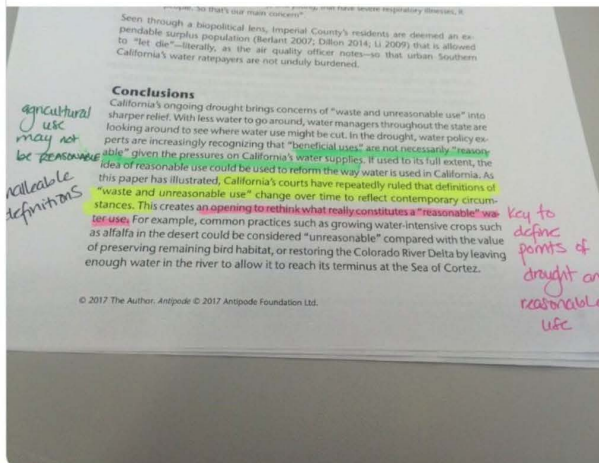
Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega
@raulpacheco

This thread walks you through how I highlight and scribble an entire journal article. In my thread, each tweet shares analytical insights that I then use to write a memorandum. [x.com/raulpacheco/st...](https://x.com/raulpacheco/status/1100000000000000000)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega @raulpacheco

Alida Cantor argues "beneficial uses are not necessarily reasonable given the pressures on California's water..."



6:22 AM · Feb 27, 2019



23



Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega
@raulpacheco



Replying to @raulpacheco

Here I explain how I expand from a Synthetic Note to a Memorandum (using the previous Twitter thread on Dr. Alida Cantor's paper

raulpacheco.org/2017/05/writin...) I use those

memorandums to create text for my book chapters, books and journal articles. #AcWri #PhDChat

#GetYourManuscriptOut

6:24 AM · Feb 27, 2019



18



Copy link

Read 1 reply



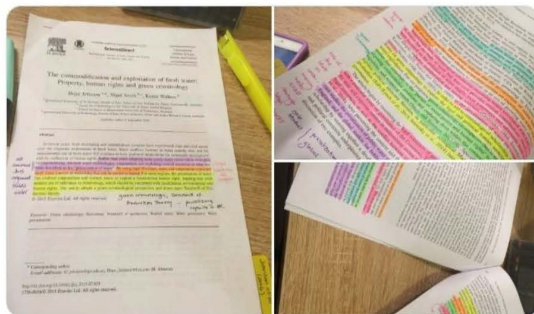
Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Feb 28, 2019



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

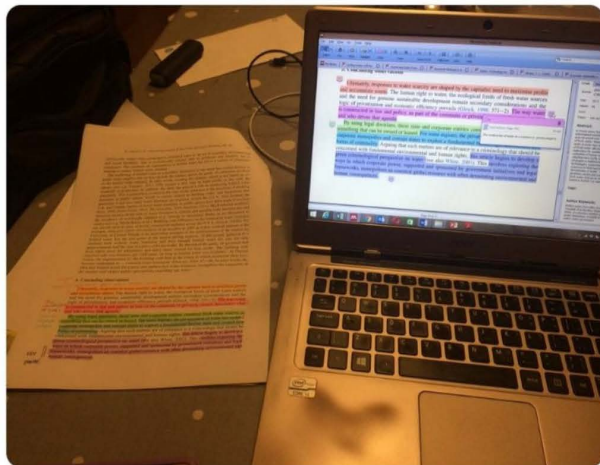
Somebody asked me how long did an AIC take. For this paper, it took 15 minutes. BUT I could recognize that this article should be read more in depth when I found a link to three R&Rs I'm working on (same paper providing insights for 3 of my projects - this rocks!)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

Since this paper will provide me with stuff I need for 3 pieces, I will write a memorandum AND store key details in my Conceptual Synthesis Excel Dump. Somebody asked me if I can do this digitally. Yes, in Mendeley you can highlight and add notes (see here)



12:29 AM · Feb 28, 2019



22



Copy link

Read 2 replies

As I mentioned above, I've written SEVERAL Twitter threads showcasing my highlighting and scribbling. Here is another one, that also includes the process of filling out a **Conceptual Synthesis Excel Dump (CSED)** row.



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

The @SarahWolfePhD et al paper I mentioned is here ecologyandsociety.org/vol22/iss3/art... (since I'm working on laptop and iPhone simultaneously I had to open a new thread). Note in my highlighting how I mark a specific section of the introduction as key for my CSED raulpacheco.org/2016/06/synthe...

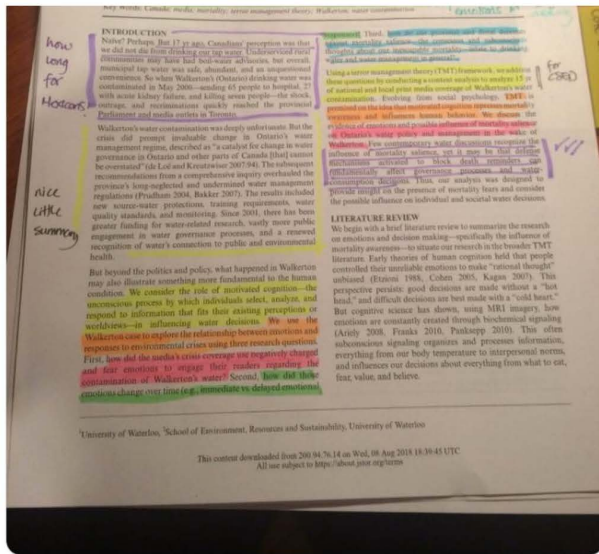


Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

I only did an AIC for this paper as it's related to what I study but not exactly to the paper I'm working on at the moment.





10:17 PM · Aug 15, 2018

♥ 2 Copy link

Read 1 reply

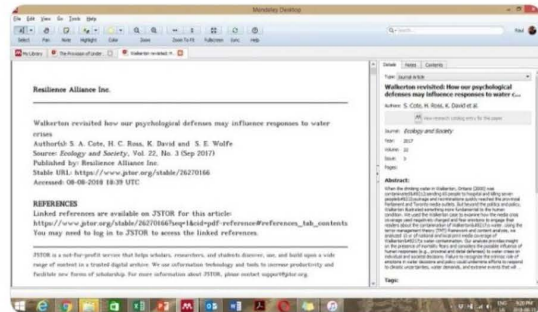


Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

I pulled Cote et al 2017 in PDF format into Mendeley, which populated the fields appropriately. From here, I copy the citation on to the first cell of my bottled water CSRD.



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

Note how the text I marked as "for CSRD" is actually written in one of the "Notes" columns of my CSRD.

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel

	C	D	E	
	Main idea	Notes 1	Notes 2	No
E. Cote et al 2017	Media influenced perceptions of safety of tap water after the 2000 Walkerton scare. Cote et al examined this case using Terror Management Theory (TMT)	Content analysis of 15 years of national and local print media coverage of Walkerton's water contamination	Emotions play a role in water decisions and water policy-making	

10:26 PM · Aug 15, 2018

♥ 2 Copy link

Read 1 reply



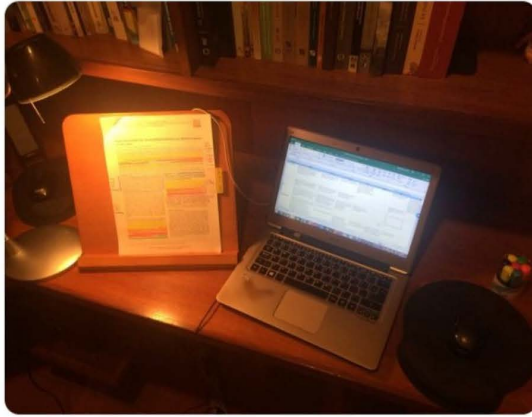
Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

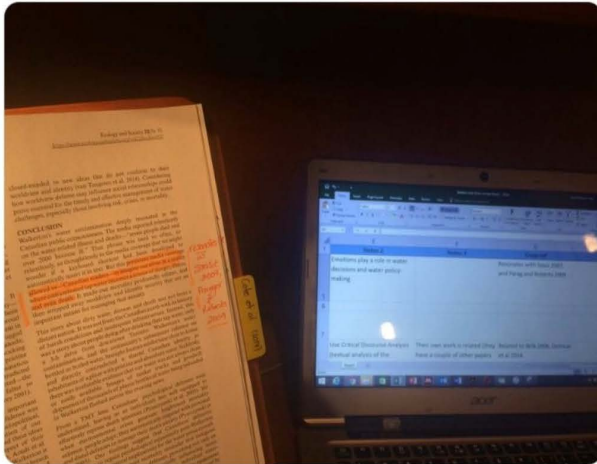
For those of you curious about the physical process, I place the highlighted article to my left so I can read it and type my notes on to a CSRD (Conceptual Synthesis Excel Dump). I designed

this wooden lectern, and had it manufactured by a great carpenter.



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega
@raulpacheco ·

Hard to do a good visual, but do note that info for my "Cross-Ref" (i.e. related works) cell comes from the article's conclusion. Sometimes I note these conexiones between different scholars/papers on the paper, sometimes directly in my CSED. But this point resonated strongly.



10:33 PM · Aug 15, 2018



♥ 1 ↻ Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega
@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel

♥ 1 ↻ Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel



1



Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018

@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common

questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel

♥ 1 ↻ Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel

♥ 1 ↻ Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel

♥ 1 ↻ Copy link

Read 1 reply



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common

dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel

♥ 1  Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

Bottled water Excel concept dump - Excel

♥ 1  Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can

♥ 1  Copy link

[Read 1 reply](#)



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega · Aug 15, 2018



@raulpacheco ·

Replying to @raulpacheco

In fact, the phrase "persistent media coverage allowed us - Canadian readers - to imagine ourselves in a reality where contaminated tap water becomes a source of danger, illness and even death." could potentially be a quotation (cell right next to "Cross Ref").



Dr Raul Pacheco-Vega

@raulpacheco ·

You can see my completed CSED row entry for the Cote et al 2017b article I linked to above. Common questions: you can change the headings of your Excel dump. You can add > 3 notes (I usually add 4th, 5th and 6th in the row underneath the main one). You can add more quotations too

